

cover story GLOBAL WARMING

Manage Disasters

With global temperatures inexorably rising, watch out for extreme weather conditions, including massive downpours as witnessed in Mumbai in recent years. Experts say that the country needs to have measures to adapt to such a crisis and minimise the adverse impacts of climate change. In cities, it would mean improving the storm water drainage system that is usually clogged and built from poor material. In coastal areas, it could mean having zoning setbacks from the seashore.

PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR



Hybrid Cars



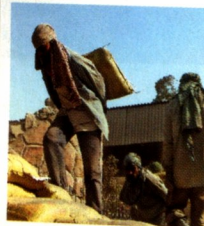
Hybrid cars have made an entry into India with Honda launching its Civic model. Essentially, it runs both on petrol and electricity, using two different but highly fuel-efficient motors. Such cars usually have advanced environment-friendly technology, including lighter materials for the body and automatic shut-off at stop lights, if you prefer it. Though priced higher than conventional models, the additional costs are meant to be recovered through fuel savings.

Cement it

Cement production in India more than trebled in the past decade and with the construction boom is poised to grow further. Though the per capita consumption is still low, with such units being one of the main contributors to emissions from the industrial sector, there is a strong need to make them fuel-efficient.

Fresh Air

In cities, the major source of air pollution is emissions from vehicles. Delhi made a significant reduction to its pollution levels by mandating its buses to run on the eco-friendly Compressed Natural Gas (CNG). Some states have provided subsidies for the use and purchase of such vehicles. It's an example that many of our metros could emulate if they want their citizens to breathe clean air.



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Green Labels

The Bureau of Energy Efficiency has made it mandatory for all refrigerators to stick energy efficiency labels to help discerning consumers. Companies making air conditioners have been asked to follow suit. Electrical appliances like heaters, irons and ovens would also be asked to comply. Be on the look out for the green label when you go shopping next—it could mean plenty of saving for you.



VIRKAW SHARMA